Ascentgen Bible (Master)

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A Ray-Peat-inspired instrument for generative ascent

1. Origin and problem

1.1 Personal origin story

Ascentgen began as a survival tool, not a startup concept.

I'm a man in my early 30s, a freelance video editor, who spent years trying to fix hair loss, weight gain, psoriasis, and collapsing energy with protocols, supplements, and "biohacking." My labs often looked "normal," but my life did not. I gained roughly 35 pounds, my hair loss and psoriasis accelerated, my CO_2 dropped, and I slid into a low-energy, low-resilience state that felt like accelerated aging.

Deeper testing eventually showed the underlying picture: functional hypothyroidism with a T4→rT3 conversion issue and steroidogenic collapse (very low pregnenolone, progesterone, and DHEA-S). The system was running on stress hormones, scraping by.

Discovering Ray Peat's work pulled this into a coherent frame. Instead of treating hair, skin, and weight as isolated "problems," the focus shifted to restoring systemic metabolic function: thyroid, oxidative metabolism, CO_2 production, and protective steroids, over a realistic time frame.

The simplest, most powerful practical change was tracking waking and post-meal temperature and pulse every day. Those four numbers became my most honest feedback loop:

- When they warmed and steadied, I felt warmer, calmer, clearer, more resilient.
- When they fell or swung, sleep, mood, digestion, and hair followed.

Ascentgen is built from that experience. It exists to give others the same clear signal: a way to see whether they are moving out of dormancy and suppression into a more generative, ascending state.

1.2 What Ascentgen is

Ascentgen is a minimalist metabolic dashboard focused on four readings:

- Waking temperature
- Post-meal temperature
- Waking pulse
- Post-meal pulse

It:

- Makes these readings easy to log every day.
- Shows clean trends over time (especially 14–30 days).
- Computes a Generative Quotient (GQ) score over recent days (0–100) that reflects how generative your metabolism appears.
- Describes your current pattern in plain language (Cold & Slow, Hot but Wired, Warm & Steady), mapped to three bands: Dormant, Kindling, and Ascending.

Ascentgen does not aim to be an all-in-one health OS. It is a focused instrument panel for heat, rhythm, and generative ascent.

In its first phase, Ascentgen assumes you are using a simple glass or digital thermometer and manual pulse counting. In later phases, Ascentgen may pair with a dedicated Ascentgen Probe that automates these readings and sends them into the app after each measurement. The philosophy is the same: minimal friction, maximal clarity.

2. Philosophy and scope

2.1 Core beliefs

Ascentgen is built on a Ray-Peat-inspired bioenergetic view of health:

- Energy production is primary

Health is not merely the absence of disease; it is the presence of energy that can create, repair, and differentiate. Adequate thyroid function and oxidative metabolism, with high CO_2 production, are central.

- Energy and structure are interdependent

  Structure depends on the quality and abundance of energy, and energy depends on healthy structure. You cannot separate them.

- Temperature and pulse are central, practical markers

  Waking and post-meal temperature and pulse are the most accessible, day-to-day window into thyroid adequacy, oxidative metabolism, and the balance between generative energy and stress chemistry.

- Generative energy > heroic suffering

  Regeneration comes from sufficient, well-organized energy, not from chronic deprivation or heroic stress. Ascent is not a grind; it's the return of warmth and coherence.

- Structure is medicine

  Sleep, routine, sobriety, spiritual practice, and emotional work are structural interventions that lower stress chemistry and support generative energy, not optional "lifestyle hacks."

- Hair, skin, and body composition are outputs

  Hair loss, graying, psoriasis, and fat gain reflect deeper metabolic and hormonal states. They are important, but they are outputs, not primary targets.

- Small, reversible moves

  Dietary and thyroid changes are best made slowly, one lever at a time, and evaluated over 7–14 days with temp/pulse trends—not in response to single numbers.

- Tools must clarify, not confuse

  A health tool should reduce anxiety and noise, not add complexity, gamification, and fear.

2.2 What Ascentgen is not

Ascentgen is deliberately narrow:

- It is not a general “biohacking” dashboard.
- It is not a supplement store disguised as an app.
- It is not a diagnostic device or replacement for medical care.
- It is not an official Ray Peat product or endorsed by his estate.
- It is not a gamified “health score” toy.

Ascentgen is a calm, focused tracker for temp, pulse, and generative patterns, with minimal, principled interpretation.

2.3 One-sentence definition

Ascentgen helps you track waking and post-meal temperature and pulse, visualize your metabolic trends, and see your Generative Quotient (GQ) as you move through Dormant, Kindling, and Ascending.

2.4 Generative energy and ascent

In the Peat-inspired frame, health is not just the absence of disease, but the presence of energy that can create, repair, and differentiate—energy abundant enough to support wholeness rather than mere survival. That kind of energy depends on efficient oxidative metabolism: thyroid-supported respiration that produces plenty of carbon dioxide, protects against lactic, stress-driven states, and supports protective steroids like pregnenolone and progesterone.

In that frame, ascent is not hustle or self-optimization. It is the movement from cold, lactic, stress-dominated metabolism toward a warmer, CO_2-rich, generative state in which structure, meaning, and resilience can be restored. For an Orthodox Christian, it can also echo participation in the divine energies of God: leaving the numbness of spiritual and physiological torpor for a more living, responsive warmth.

Ascentgen takes this high-level idea and gives it a daily handle. Rising, stabilizing temperature and pulse are treated as small, practical signs that generative energy is increasing—that you are moving through Dormant, into Kindling, and eventually into Ascending.

3. Measurement protocol

Ascentgen only works if measurements are consistent and honest. This section defines how users should measure so the data is meaningful.

3.1 Temperature measurement

Goal: basal-style readings that reflect your resting state, not quick clinical checks.

Thermometer:

- Use a glass thermometer or a slower digital thermometer that can remain in place for several minutes.
- Avoid relying on instant forehead/ear readings for trends.

Choose one location and stick with it:

- Oral (under the tongue), or
- Axillary (underarm).

3.1.1 Waking temperature

- Take immediately upon waking, before getting out of bed or using your phone.
- If you must get up briefly, minimize activity and lie back down for a few minutes before measuring.

Oral:

- Place thermometer deep under the tongue.
- Close mouth fully.
- Keep it in place for several minutes (glass: ~10 minutes; digital: ignore quick beep and leave longer).
- Record the reading and “oral” as the location.

Axillary:

- Ensure armpit is dry.
- Place thermometer high in the armpit.
- Press arm firmly against torso.

- Keep it in place for 10–15 minutes (glass) or several minutes (digital).
- Record the reading and “axillary” as the location.

3.1.2 Post-meal temperature

- Measure 45–60 minutes after your first substantial meal of the day.
- That meal should include:
  - Meaningful protein
  - Carbohydrate
  - Some saturated fat
- Sit quietly for a few minutes before measuring.
- Use the same location and method as waking.

3.1.3 Reference directions for temperature

These are directions, not rigid targets:

- Waking temperature trending toward about 36.6°C / 97.8°F.
- Post-meal temperature trending toward about 37.0°C / 98.6°F.

Small daily fluctuations are normal. The trend over 7–14+ days is what matters.

3.2 Pulse measurement

Pulse must be measured consistently.

Where:

- Radial pulse (wrist), or
- Carotid pulse (side of neck, gently).

Use index and middle finger (never your thumb).

3.2.1 Waking pulse

- After waking temp, still lying down or sitting quietly.

- Find your pulse and count beats for a full 60 seconds.
- Breathe normally; don’t consciously slow or speed your breathing.

3.2.2 Post-meal pulse

- Take at the same time as post-meal temperature (45–60 minutes after the first substantial meal).
- Sit quietly a few minutes before counting.
- Count beats for 60 seconds.

3.2.3 Reference directions for pulse

Directions, not strict targets:

- A calm resting pulse in the 60–85 bpm range, in a well-fed, warm person, often reflects adequate thyroid-driven output.
- Slightly higher pulse post-meal (e.g., +5–10 bpm) can be normal if it feels calm and non-anxious.

The key contrast is between:

- Calm, full, steady pulse vs.
- Thin, pounding, racing, or anxious pulse (stress-driven).

3.3 Consistency, notes, practice, and reminders

Consistency is the limiting factor.

Daily minimum:

- Waking temperature
- Waking pulse
- Post-meal temperature
- Post-meal pulse

Highly recommended notes:

- Sleep duration and quality

- Obvious stressors (travel, conflict, illness)
- Training (rest, light, heavy)
- Changes in diet, meds, thyroid, or supplements
- Key symptoms (digestion, mood, hair/skin, energy)

Ascentgen assumes you might only log these four numbers plus notes. Everything else is optional.

App reminders and alarms

Ascentgen can optionally remind you when to measure:

- Morning baseline reminder at your chosen wake window.
- Post-meal reminder 45–60 minutes after logging your first substantial meal.

Reminders are prompts, not commands. The more often you respond within the same window each day, the more meaningful your GQ trends become.

4. Patterns and interpretation

Ascentgen does descriptive, not diagnostic, interpretation. It gives clear patterns you can reflect on and, if needed, discuss with a practitioner.

4.1 Time horizons

Interpretation horizon:

- Main lens: rolling 14-day window for GQ and patterns.
- Weekly lens: 7-day summaries and week-to-week changes.
- Context: multi-month views later.

Individual days are noisy. Patterns emerge over weeks, not hours.

4.2 Three primary metabolic patterns

Ascentgen classifies your recent data into three broad patterns.

4.2.1 Cold & Slow – Dormant pattern

Characteristic signs:

- Waking temps often below ~36.4°C / 97.6°F.
- Post-meal temps only rise slightly or remain low.
- Waking and daytime pulse often in the 50s–60s, with sluggish energy and low mood.

Interpretation:

- Often indicates a Dormant band: suppressed metabolic state, under-fueled and/or functionally hypothyroid, with generative energy low or scattered.
- The system is producing less energy and CO_2 than it needs and may rely on stress hormones to cope.

Ascentgen label:

- Pattern: “Cold & Slow”.
- GQ band: typically Dormant.

4.2.2 Hot but Wired – Mis-fired energy pattern

Characteristic signs:

- Temperatures may look “normal” or even high at times.
- Pulse often 90+ bpm at rest, with anxious or pounding sensations.
- Subjective symptoms: anxiety, irritability, poor sleep, crashes after stress or intense training.

Interpretation:

- Often indicates mis-fired energy: stress chemistry (adrenaline, cortisol) driving heart rate and warmth more than calm thyroid support.
- The body appears “revved” on numbers but is not in a truly generative, coherent state.

Ascentgen label:

- Pattern: “Hot but Wired”.

- GQ band: can still be Dormant or early Kindling, depending on temps and stability.

4.2.3 Warm & Steady – Ascending pattern

Characteristic signs:

- Waking temps usually in the high 36s°C / high 97s°F.
- Post-meal temps regularly near 37.0°C / 98.6°F.
- Pulse mostly in the 70s–80s, calm and full but not jittery.
- Subjective: better sleep, digestion, mood, hair, and capacity for stress and training.

Interpretation:

- Indicates an Ascending band: warm, steady, generative state where oxidative metabolism and structure support each other.
- Energy isn't just present; it's organized in a way that supports repair, creativity, and resilience.

Ascentgen label:

- Pattern: "Warm & Steady".
- GQ band: typically Ascending.

5. Generative Quotient (GQ) – conceptual spec

5.1 Definition

GQ (Generative Quotient) is a 0–100 index that summarizes how generative your metabolism appears over a recent window (default: last 14 days), based on:

- Average waking temperature
- Average post-meal temperature
- Average waking pulse
- Average post-meal pulse

- Stability (how much they fluctuate)

GQ is:

- A compass, not a diagnosis.
- A way to see direction: whether you are moving through Dormant, Kindling, and into Ascending.
- Always interpreted alongside lived experience.

5.2 Target values

Ascentgen uses internal targets that approximate a warm, steady, generative state:

- Waking temp ideal: 36.6 °C (≈ 97.8°F).
- Post-meal temp ideal: 37.0 °C (≈ 98.6°F).
- Waking pulse ideal: 75 bpm.
- Post-meal pulse ideal: 82 bpm.

Temperatures in Fahrenheit are converted to Celsius internally.

5.3 Components (high-level)

Over the chosen window (e.g., 14 days), Ascentgen computes:

- A closeness score (0–1) for each metric vs its ideal (waking temp, post-meal temp, waking pulse, post-meal pulse).
- A stability score (0–1) based on standard deviations for those metrics (lower variability = higher stability).

It then combines:

- Temperature closeness (avg temps)
- Pulse closeness (avg pulses)
- Stability (overall steadiness)

into a 0–100 GQ, with weights favoring both “how close” and “how steady.”

5.4 GQ tiers and meanings

Tiers (conceptual):

- 0–69 → Dormant
- 70–89 → Kindling
- 90–100 → Ascending

Dormant (0–69)

Colder and/or unstable patterns. Heat and rhythm are not yet organized; generative energy is mostly dormant or scattered.

Kindling (70–89)

Temps and pulse are warming and becoming more coherent, but still somewhat fragile or variable. This is the “fire catching” band.

Ascending (90–100)

Temps and pulse are close to targets and stable. Reflects a warm, steady, generative pattern where energy production and structure support each other.

GQ is most useful as a story of movement across Dormant, Kindling, and Ascending over weeks and months, not as a single number to hit on a given day.

6. Product model and features (MVP)

6.1 Core data model

User

- id
- email / auth fields
- settings:
  - temperature_unit (“C” / “F”)
  - time_zone
  - notification preferences

DailyEntry

- id
- user_id
- date (YYYY-MM-DD)
- waking_temp_value (float)
- waking_temp_unit (“C” / “F”)
- waking_pulse_bpm (int)
- post_meal_temp_value (float, nullable)
- post_meal_temp_unit (“C” / “F”, nullable)
- post_meal_pulse_bpm (int, nullable)
- notes (text, optional)
- created_at, updated_at

GQSnapshot

- id
- user_id
- start_date (window start)
- end_date (window end)
- gq_score (int, 0–100)
- gq_tier (“Dormant”, “Kindling”, “Ascending”)
- created_at

6.2 Free features (non-negotiable core)

Free forever:

Logging

- Waking temp & pulse.
- Post-meal temp & pulse.
- Notes.

Visualization

- List/table of last 14–30 days of entries.
- Simple line charts (14–30 days) for:
  - Waking temperature
  - Post-meal temperature
  - Waking pulse
  - Post-meal pulse

GQ & patterns

- Rolling 14-day GQ calculation.
- GQ tier label: Dormant / Kindling / Ascending.
- Weekly pattern tag: Cold & Slow, Hot but Wired, Warm & Steady.
- Short explanations pulled from copy bank.

Weekly summary

- “This week vs last week” averages for temps and pulse.
- GQ change (e.g., 64 → 78) with a simple arrow and one-line commentary.

6.3 Future paid layers (concept only)

Paid layers, if developed, sit on top of the free core:

- Advanced views: 3-, 6-, 12-month charts; phase overlays.
- Reports & exports: PDFs, CSVs.
- Guided programs: e.g., 14-day baseline, 6–8 week GQ ascent cohorts.
- Contextual suggestion modules framed as options, not prescriptions.

Core tracking, trends, and GQ remain free.

6.4 Hardware: Ascentgen Probe (concept)

Ascentgen is designed to work with manual readings and to stand alone as a web app. In a future phase, it may integrate with a dedicated hardware device.

Ascentgen Probe (concept only):

- Oral thermometer + pulse sensor that captures temperature and pulse simultaneously under the tongue.
- Uses a high-precision thermistor for temperature and an optical PPG sensor for pulse, similar to medical pulse oximeter technology.
- Built-in vibration motor signals when a stable reading is reached (~60–120 seconds).
- Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) is disabled while in-mouth; during measurement the probe behaves as a passive sensor with local storage only.
- After removal, the device briefly wakes the BLE radio, transmits the reading to Ascentgen in a short burst, and powers the radio back down.
- Rechargeable battery with USB-C charging, ideally via a small desk/nightstand dock matching the brand's gold accent.
- Device cannot be used while charging (hard lockout) for safety.

EMF stance

- Sensing first, transmission second.
- No active radio during in-mouth contact.
- Vibration is purely mechanical, not RF.

This hardware is a future, optional layer. The core app remains fully usable with simple thermometers and manual pulse counting.

7. Brand system

7.1 Visual identity

Feel

- Dark, contemplative, minimal.
- Feels like a quiet, serious instrument panel, not a playful fitness app.

Color palette (example hexes)

- Background: near-black with warm undertone (#050509).
- Card/surface: dark slate (#101017).
- Main text: soft off-white (#E5E7EB).
- Quote/highlight text: warm cream (#F5E9C8).
- Accent gold: (#D3A84D).
- Subtle gold: (#C9973C).
- Lines/borders: graphite (#272738).

Logo and mark

- Wordmark: “Ascentgen” in uppercase serif, slightly tracked out.
- Mark: AG monogram – a circle with an ascending arrow/thermometer in the center and an apex triangle – used as favicon/app icon and as the central “instrument” motif.
- In UI, the main GQ gauge visually echoes this mark: circular gauge + central vertical thermometer bar.

7.2 Typography

Two families:

- Serif (brand, quotes, large phrases) – e.g., Cormorant Garamond, Playfair Display, EB Garamond.
- Sans-serif (UI and body) – e.g., Inter, Manrope.

Rules:

- Serif for logo, big brand headlines, key quotes.
- Sans-serif for all labels, numbers, buttons, and paragraphs.
- Use all-caps sans with extra tracking for small labels (“GQ HISTORY · 14 DAYS”).
- Keep UI text slightly larger than typical for a calm, non-rushed feel.

7.3 Layout and interaction

- Single main column centered on larger screens; full-width with padding on mobile.
- Ample negative space around charts and numbers.
- One primary CTA per screen (e.g., “Begin your ascent”, “Record today’s ascent”).
- Animations: simple fades or slides; no flashy motion.

8. Voice, copy, and ethics

8.1 Tone and personality

Ascentgen’s voice is:

- Calm, precise, slightly poetic but always clear.
- Serious about physiology without being clinical or cold.
- Empathetic to people who feel “broken” by complex health issues and normal labs.
- Explicit about limits and uncertainty.

It avoids:

- Hype, memes, and “secret hack” language.
- Fear-based marketing or catastrophizing.
- Over-promising.

8.2 Core phrases and language

Reusable lines:

- “Begin your ascent.”
- “Track heat and rhythm at your core.”
- “From Dormant to Ascending.”
- “Your Generative Quotient (GQ) traces Dormant, Kindling, and Ascending.”
- “Structure is medicine.”

- “Systemic metabolic repair is primary; local or cosmetic tools are secondary.”
- “Ascentgen listens to four readings: waking and post-meal temperature and pulse.”

8.3 Microcopy and patterns

Buttons

- “Begin your ascent” (landing).
- “Enter Ascentgen” (open app).
- “Record today’s ascent” (log screen).
- “Lock in today’s readings” (save form).
- “Review your last ascent” (GQ history).
- “Decode your GQ” (learn more).

Empty states

- “No readings yet. Start with tomorrow’s waking temperature and pulse.”
- “Give us seven days of readings and we’ll show you your first GQ.”
- “We can’t trace an ascent without data. Start small, stay consistent.”

Errors

- “We couldn’t save that entry. Please check your connection and try again.”
- “Something went wrong loading your readings. Refresh or try again in a moment.”
- “GQ needs at least seven days of readings. Keep logging and check back soon.”

Pattern blurbs

- Cold & Slow – Dormant

  “Colder temps, flatter response to meals, and lower pulse suggest a Cold & Slow pattern—a Dormant band where generative energy hasn’t lit up yet.”

- Hot but Wired – mis-fired energy

"Temps may look fine, but a high, erratic pulse and wired feeling often mean mis-fired energy—a stress-driven mix of Dormant and early Kindling, more alarm than ascent."

- Warm & Steady – Ascending

  "Warm, steady temps and a calm pulse suggest a Warm & Steady pattern—the Ascending band where generative energy is supporting repair and life."

8.4 Ethics and lines

Commitments

- Core tracking (temp/pulse logging, basic charts, GQ, pattern labels) stays free.
- Ascentgen will not present itself as a diagnostic tool or replacement for medical care.
- Ascentgen will not sell miracle cures or promise specific outcomes.
- Any advanced education or coaching is clearly optional and not required to benefit from the tracker.

Disclaimers

- Ascentgen is not medical care; users should work with clinicians for diagnosis and treatment.
- Ascentgen is inspired by, but not affiliated with, Ray Peat or his estate.
- Ascentgen's role is to make one crucial signal—heat and rhythm—visible, so you can see whether your ascent is real.

9. Generative Quotient (GQ) – App implementation (2026-04-26)

Note: This section documents the current live implementation (v0.2) in the app. It is allowed to differ slightly from the more general conceptual spec in section 5 while we iterate. When they diverge, this section is the source of truth for code behavior.

Definition

Generative Quotient (GQ) is a 0–100 score that summarizes how closely and how stably waking and post-meal temperature and pulse match the generative targets over recent days (14, 30, 90).

It is not “Growth Quotient”; all language in app and docs should use Generative Quotient (GQ).

Targets used in code

All scoring is done in Celsius internally (UI may show Fahrenheit):

- Waking temp: 36.6 °C.
- Post-meal temp: 37.0 °C.
- Waking pulse: 75 bpm.
- Post-meal pulse: 82 bpm.

Data source

Supabase table daily_entries with:

- date, waking_temp_value/_unit, waking_pulse_bpm, post_meal_temp_value/_unit, post_meal_pulse_bpm, user_id.

The app converts Fahrenheit to Celsius for scoring, but preserves original units in storage.

Windows

- 14-day GQ (current main view): uses last 14 days of entries (requires ≥ 7 days).
- 30-day GQ.
- 90-day GQ.

Closeness to targets (v0.2)

For each metric:

- Temperatures:
  - score 1.0 if within ±0.2 °C of ideal.
  - score 0.0 if ≥ 0.9 °C away.
  - linear between 0.2 and 0.9 °C.

- Pulse:
  - score 1.0 if within ±3 bpm of ideal.
  - score 0.0 if ≥ 20 bpm away.
  - linear between 3 and 20 bpm.

Stability (standard deviation)

- Temperature SD:
  - 1.0 if SD ≤ 0.15 °C.
  - 0.0 if SD ≥ 0.6 °C.
  - linear between 0.15 and 0.6 °C.
- Pulse SD:
  - 1.0 if SD ≤ 3 bpm.
  - 0.0 if SD ≥ 12 bpm.
  - linear between 3 and 12 bpm.

Composite scores

- TempScore = average of waking/post-meal temp closeness.
- PulseScore = average of waking/post-meal pulse closeness.
- StabilityScore = average of the four stability scores.

Final GQ

- GQ_raw = 100 × (0.35 × TempScore + 0.35 × PulseScore + 0.30 × StabilityScore)
- Clamp to 0–100 and round to nearest integer.

Tiers

- GQ < 70 → “Dormant”.
- 70–89 → “Kindling”.
- ≥ 90 → “Ascending”.

Patterns (7-day)

- Uses 7-day averages + pulse SD.
- “Cold & Slow”: temps below warm band.
- “Warm & Steady”: temps warm, pulse moderate, low variability.
- “Hot but Wired”: pulse high and/or unstable even if temps warm.

Current app status

- v0.2 GQ scoring is implemented in gq.ts.
- Daily entries are stored via a Today Check-In form.
- Recent entries list + inline editing exists; minor dev-tooling issues to resolve before fully exposing.